

DRAFT WRITTEN PARLIAMENTARY QUESTIONS

Re: the MoJ Splink record-linkage programme and the "probation-to-police" pilot

For: the Office of Iqbal Mohamed MP. Use, cut, merge or re-word freely. **Drafting notes:** - Each question is written to be **specific and answerable**, and to reference the Government's *own* Algorithmic Transparency Records so the Department cannot plead ignorance of the system. - Questions are addressed to **the Secretary of State for Justice** unless marked otherwise. A short set for the **Home Office** (Palantir) is included at the end to keep the two tracks clean. - A "we do not hold this information" or refusal answer to several of these is itself newsworthy — they are designed so that evasion is conspicuous.

A. The North Essex "probation-to-police" pilot

1. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice, with reference to the Algorithmic Transparency Record "Splink Master Record," published 6 October 2025, whether her Department will publish the **Data Protection Impact Assessment** for the North Essex pilot in which Police National Computer numbers of individuals under probation supervision are shared with the police.
 2. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice what the **statutory legal basis** is for sharing the Police National Computer numbers of probation-supervised individuals with police forces on a daily basis under the pilot described in the "Splink Master Record" transparency record.
 3. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether there is a **data-sharing agreement or memorandum of understanding** governing the North Essex probation-to-police data-sharing pilot, and whether she will place a copy in the Library.
 4. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice **how many individuals'** Police National Computer numbers have been shared with the police under the North Essex pilot, and over what period.
 5. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether individuals whose Police National Computer numbers are shared with the police under the North Essex pilot are **informed** that their data is being shared, and whether any mechanism exists for them to **object**.
 6. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether the North Essex probation-to-police data-sharing pilot has been **evaluated**, and whether she plans to **extend** it to other police force areas or to a national footprint.
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B. The "Core Person Record" (real-time identification)

7. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice, with reference to the "Splink Master Record" transparency record, what **stage** the "Core Person Record" is at, and whether it is operating on **live, identifiable** data about individuals in the prison, probation and criminal-court systems.
 8. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether a **Data Protection Impact Assessment** has been completed for the Core Person Record, and whether she will publish it.
 9. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice what **decisions about individuals** the Core Person Record is used to inform or make, and whether any are **solely automated** within the meaning of the data protection legislation as amended by the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025.
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C. Probabilistic linkage, error and consequence

10. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice what the **target and observed false-positive (incorrect match) and false-negative (missed match) rates** are for the Splink record-linkage used operationally across prison, probation and court data.
 11. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice what **safeguards** exist to prevent an incorrect probabilistic match from resulting in the wrong individual's records being used in **preparing a case for sentence**, as described in the "Splink Master Record" transparency record, and what **recourse** an individual has if such an error occurs.
 12. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice what **match-probability threshold** is applied before a Splink-generated link between records about an individual is acted upon operationally.
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D. Legal basis, consent and the research/operational boundary

13. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice how she **reconciles** the statement in the "MoJ: Data First (Splink)" transparency record that the data is "not for operational decision-making" with the operational, person-identifying uses of the same Splink tool described in the "Splink Master Record" transparency record.
 14. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether the operational uses of Splink described in the "Splink Master Record" transparency record rely on **consent**, and if not, on what alternative lawful basis under the UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 they rely.
 15. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether the **Information Commissioner's Office** has been consulted on, or has reviewed, the operational (non-research) uses of Splink across prison, probation, court and police data.
 16. To ask the Secretary of State for Justice whether she will commit to publishing a **single consolidated account** of every operational deployment of the Splink tool on identifiable individuals across the justice system, including the legal basis and DPIA for each.
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E. Optional — to the Home Office (the Palantir track; keep separate from the above)

H1. To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department, further to the answers given on Data Protection Impact Assessments for the Palantir data-platform trial, whether her Department will publish the **unredacted** DPIA(s) for that trial.

H2. To ask the Secretary of State for the Home Department whether any data processed in the Palantir data-platform trial is **shared with, or derived from**, the Ministry of Justice's record-linkage systems, and if so, under what legal basis.

(H2 is worded to confirm — on the record — whether the two tracks meet. The honest research finding is that there is no documented link; a clear "no" from the Department closes that loop usefully, and anything other than "no" is significant.)

A note on sequencing: table the A and D blocks first — the North Essex pilot and the research/operational contradiction are the strongest, most concrete, and hardest to deflect. B, C and the Home Office set make good follow-ups once the first answers (and non-answers) are in.